

Captain Acquisition & Airport Supply

1. Executive Summary

The captain acquisition problem is primarily an **onboarding-friction problem**, with the largest loss occurring during RC verification. The evidence points toward document-capture and verification issues, particularly for captains using lower-end devices. The priority should therefore be to reduce RC friction before increasing acquisition volume.

The current WhatsApp campaign does not provide sufficient evidence to justify a large-scale expansion. Because campaign exposure was observational and much of the messaging occurred after the approval decision, its observed relationship with approval cannot be interpreted causally. Future campaigns should be evaluated through randomized holdouts before scaling.

The airport problem appears to be a **time-specific supply and captain-economics problem**, rather than a simple shortage of airport-catchment captains. Terminal pressure is concentrated overnight, while post-airport-trip behavior suggests that destination and return-fare economics may influence captain willingness to serve certain trips. This supports a targeted overnight intervention rather than broad acquisition.

2. Captain acquisition

The onboarding funnel shows that the largest loss occurs around **RC clearance**. The concentration of verification failures around image quality and OCR suggests that some of this loss may be preventable through better document capture.

The strongest intervention is therefore to improve the onboarding experience rather than simply increase top-of-funnel acquisition. This could include clearer document-capture guidance, pre-upload image-quality checks, and better retake flows, with particular attention to lower-end devices.

The expected impact should be validated through an experiment rather than assumed from historical correlations.

3. Campaign

CAMP_WA_002 should **not be scaled 5× on the current evidence**.

The main issue is not simply the observed approval difference. Campaign exposure was not randomized, and a large share of messages were sent after the approval decision. This makes a raw comparison between campaign recipients and non-recipients unsuitable for estimating incremental impact.

The next step should be a randomized holdout test measuring **incremental approval lift**. Scaling should follow only if the experiment demonstrates a meaningful improvement.

4. Airport supply

Airport terminal supply pressure is strongly concentrated during **overnight hours**. This suggests that broad acquisition of airport-catchment captains would spend resources outside the periods where the marketplace actually needs additional supply.

Post-trip behavior provides an additional signal: suburban airport destinations have weaker return-fare availability and higher captain cancellation than other destinations. This suggests that **captain economics may be part of the supply problem**.

The first intervention should therefore be a targeted overnight pilot using incentives, repositioning, or return-fare support. The key question is whether this generates **incremental supply and fulfilled demand**, rather than simply moving existing captains from other zones.

5. Recommended priorities

1. Reduce RC onboarding friction

- Improve document capture and verification, especially for lower-end devices.

2. Run a targeted overnight airport pilot

- Focus on the hours and destinations where supply pressure and captain economics are weakest.

3. Introduce randomized evaluation for growth campaigns

- Do not scale onboarding campaigns without evidence of incremental impact.

What would change the decision?

The RC intervention should be reconsidered if controlled testing fails to produce incremental approvals. The airport strategy should change if an overnight intervention only shifts existing supply or fails to generate sufficient marketplace benefit. Campaign expansion should be reconsidered if randomized testing demonstrates meaningful incremental approval lift.